

Qalqalah — The Bouncing Letters

■ This is a study companion for your Tajweed course. Each bullet point is a key concept from the video lecture. Review these pointers before or after each lesson.

What is Qalqalah?

- Qalqalah (■■■■■■■■) = a slight bouncing echo sound on 5 specific letters
- Occurs when any of these letters has sukoon (no vowel) or at a stop
- The sound is like a tiny 'bounce' after the letter — a very slight vowel echo
- Without Qalqalah the recitation sounds flat and dead
- With Qalqalah it sounds vibrant, alive, and textured

The 5 Qalqalah Letters

- ■ (Qaaf) ■ (Taa) ■ (Ba) ■ (Jeem) ■ (Daal)
- Mnemonic: ■■■■■■ ■■■■■■ (poles of a grandfather)
- All 5 are: voiced + strong (■■■■■ ■■■■■) letters
- These characteristics naturally create the bouncing echo sound
- NO OTHER LETTERS have Qalqalah — only these exact 5

When Does Qalqalah Occur?

- CONDITION 1: When the Qalqalah letter has SUKOOK within a word
Example: ■■■■■■■■ — the ■ has damma (no Qalqalah here)
Example: ■■■■■■■■■■ — the ■ before Kaaf has sukoon → Qalqalah
- CONDITION 2: When you STOP on a word ending in a Qalqalah letter
At a stop, the final vowel is removed → the letter becomes sukoon → Qalqalah
- IMPORTANT: No Qalqalah when the letter has a VOWEL (fatha/damma/kasra)

3 Degrees of Qalqalah Strength

- WEAK (■■■■■■■■): Qalqalah letter has sukoon in the MIDDLE of a word
Sound: slight, gentle bounce
Example: ■■■■■■■■ — slight bounce on ■ within the word
- MEDIUM (■■■■■■■■): Stopping on a word where the letter has one sukoon
Sound: medium, clear bounce
Example: Stopping on ■■■■■■ — clear bounce on the ■■
- STRONG (■■■■■■■■): Stopping on a word where the letter has SHADDA
Sound: strong, prominent bounce
Example: Stopping on ■■■■■■ — strong bounce on ■■ (Surah Al-Masad)

Quranic Examples

- ■■■■ ■■■■ ■■■■ ■■■■ (Surah Al-Ikhlās):
 - ■■■■: Laam has sukoon (but Laam is not Qalqalah!)
 - Stopping on ■■■■: MEDIUM Qalqalah on the Daal
- ■■■■ ■■■■ ■■■■ ■■■■ ■■■■ ■■■■ (Surah Al-Masad):
 - Stopping on ■■■■: STRONG Qalqalah on Ba with Shadda
- ■■■■ ■■■■ ■■■■ (Surah Al-Alaq):
 - ■■■■: Qaaf has Fatha (no Qalqalah)
 - Stopping on ■■■■: MEDIUM Qalqalah on Qaaf

Common Mistakes with Qalqalah

- MISTAKE 1: Adding Qalqalah to letters that aren't in the 5
- MISTAKE 2: Adding Qalqalah when the letter has a vowel (fatha/kasra/damma)
- MISTAKE 3: Making the bounce too exaggerated — it's subtle, not a full vowel
- MISTAKE 4: Making the bounce too weak — it should be audible
- MISTAKE 5: Not increasing strength at a stop with Shadda
- TEST: Listen to any Qari — you will hear Qalqalah clearly on ■ ■ ■ ■ ■

Quick Reference — Qalqalah

- 5 LETTERS: ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ (mnemonic: ■■■■ ■■■■)
- CONDITION: The letter must have sukoon
- WEAK: Middle of word | MEDIUM: Stop without shadda | STRONG: Stop with shadda
- Not too exaggerated, not too weak — a clear, natural bounce
- Practice: Say 'qub' quickly — the 'b' has a natural bounce = Qalqalah
- Every stop on a Qalqalah letter = Qalqalah — never forget at stops